HISTORICAL ARCHIVAL REPORT · V1.0
REF: ESN-RFO-2026-001
MIDFIELDER AUDIT · SANTA MARIA A MONTE / BOLOGNA / MILAN
PRIMARY SOURCE: GUERIN SPORTIVO (2026-09) & CALCIO ILLUSTRATO (1966)

ROMANO FOGLI



Midfielder (Mediano / Regista) · Torino · Bologna · AC Milan · Catania · 1955–1974
Italy · **Born 21 January 1938, Santa Maria a Monte (Pisa)**
Nickname: *Il Grissino* (The Breadstick) GUERIN SPORTIVO
1963-64 Serie A Champion — Bologna LEGA SERIE A
1968-69 European Cup & 1969 Intercontinental Cup — AC Milan UEFA
13 caps — Italy · 1966 World Cup FIGC
Tier 3: BLOCKED · Retrospective feature only · **FGA NOT ISSUED**

⚠ HISTORICAL ARCHIVE · TIER 3 BLOCKED

Read this first — Tier 3 is BLOCKED, not partial. Romano Fogli played from 1955 to 1974. **No full 90-minute footage is held in this file**, and **no match-by-match event log, no line-ups, and no video-derived scoring have been performed**. The only sources are retrospective magazine features (*Guerin Sportivo*, 2026) and contemporary press (*Calcio Illustrato*, 1966) plus historical records. **The percentages and charts on this page are inferential analyst estimates only — not Tier 3 validated, not video-scored, not FGA output. No FGA rating can be issued.**

ERA	HONOURS	TIER 3	FGA RATING
1955–1974	Serie A · European Cup	BLOCKED	N/A
Torino · Bologna · Milan · Catania	Bologna 1964 · Milan 1969	0 / 12 · no event log	Withheld by rule · no proxy

1 · SUBJECT PROFILE

PLAYER CARD · IDENTITY SNAPSHOT

HISTORICAL ARCHIVE — 1960S SNAPSHOT

FULL NAME	**Romano Fogli**
BORN	**21 January 1938 · Santa Maria a Monte (Pisa), Italy**
POSITION	**Midfielder (Mediano / Regista)**
HEIGHT / WEIGHT	**1.72 m · 69 kg** GUERIN SPORTIVO
CURRENT STATUS	**Deceased — 21 September 2021 (aged 83)**

ATTRIBUTE	DETAIL
Full name	Romano Fogli
Nickname	*Il Grissino* (The Breadstick) — due to his slight build GUERIN SPORTIVO
Position	**Midfielder (Mediano / Regista)** — a technically gifted deep-lying playmaker or box-to-box midfielder GUERIN SPORTIVO
Height / Weight	1.72 m · 69 kg GUERIN SPORTIVO
Club History	**1952–1955:** Santa Maria a Monte (Dilettanti) **1955–1958:** Torino **1958–1968:** Bologna **1968–1970:** AC Milan **1970–1974:** Catania
Career Totals (League)	**280+ matches · 15+ goals** (Top flight) GUERIN SPORTIVO
League	Serie A · Serie B
Career span	1955–1974 (19 seasons)
Born	**21 January 1938, Santa Maria a Monte (Pisa), Italy** GUERIN SPORTIVO
National team	**Italy: 13 caps, 0 goals** · 1966 World Cup FIGC
Honours (Club)	**Bologna:** Serie A 1963-64 LEGA SERIE A **AC Milan:** European Cup 1968-69 · Intercontinental Cup 1969 UEFA
Honours (Individual)	— not catalogued in source
Tier 3 evidence	✖ BLOCKED — RETROSPECTIVE FEATURE ONLY, NO EVENT LOG, NO VIDEO LOG

2 · CAREER TRAJECTORY

PERIOD	CLUB / TEAM	LEAGUE	ROLE	KEY CONTEXT
1955–1958	Torino	Serie A	Midfielder	Youth product; breakthrough at 18; 2 goals in 49 apps GUERIN SPORTIVO
1958–1968	Bologna	Serie A	Midfielder	Club legend; 280+ apps; Serie A champion 1963-64; played in the 1964 Scudetto playoff GUERIN SPORTIVO
1968–1970	AC Milan	Serie A	Midfielder	Signed by Nereo Rocco; European Cup 1969; Intercontinental Cup 1969; 43 apps GUERIN SPORTIVO
1970–1974	Catania	Serie A / B	Midfielder	Veteran leader; played until age 36 GUERIN SPORTIVO
1958–1967	Italy	International	Midfielder	13 caps; 1966 World Cup FIGC

3 · THE SOURCE & QUOTES

> **Sources:** *Guerin Sportivo* (2026-09 feature) and *Calcio Illustrato* (1966). Retrospective and contemporary Italian magazine pieces with photographs, narrative prose, and direct quotes — **not contemporaneous match reports**.

3.1 · "IL CAPOSCUOLA" (THE HEADMASTER)

> *"Il calcio italiano esprimeva quel giorno di dicembre del 1958 soltanto Romano Fogli, che sta a Corso e a Rivera come un caposcuola. Tecnica pura, ai limiti del lirismo, la sua. Il football di casa nostra partoriva il primo 'enfant prodige', il capostipite degli 'abatini'..."*
>
> — Lino Cascioli, Il Calcio Illustrato, 26 June 1966

A powerful framing of Fogli's historical role. In the late 1950s, Italian football was still recovering from the Superga tragedy and the defensive era. Fogli was seen as the **pioneer of a new, technically gifted generation** — the "caposcuola" (headmaster) who paved the way for the likes of Gianni Rivera and Mario Corso. He combined *tecnica pura* (pure technique) with a willingness to sacrifice himself defensively.

3.2 · "IL GIOCO MINIATTO" (THE MINIATURE GAME)

> *"Fogli ha la classe innata di chi trova facilissime le cose difficili, di chi realizza l'impossibile. Abbiamo visto molti celeberrimi assi fare, davanti a lui, la figura dei principianti. Preferisce le mezzali tecniche, che accettano il confronto sul terreno delle reciproche finezze. Il suo gioco è miniato, cesellato."*
>
> — Gian Paolo Ormezzano, Lo Sport, 27 March 1958

A description of Fogli's technical elegance. He was not a physical powerhouse (hence the "Grissino" nickname), but he was **majestic in possession**, using close control and precise passing to dictate the tempo. The phrase "miniato, cesellato" (miniature, chiselled) captures the artistry of his game.

3.3 · THE 1964 SCUDETTO PLAYOFF

The defining match of his Bologna career. On 7 June 1964, Bologna faced Inter in a playoff for the Serie A title at the Stadio Olimpico in Rome. Fogli was the **undisputed man of the match**. He opened the scoring with a deflected free-kick and then provided the assist for Harald Nielsen's decisive second goal. Bologna won 2-0, securing their first Scudetto in 23 years. It was a performance that cemented his legacy as a big-game player.

3.4 · THE 1969 EUROPEAN CUP SEMI-FINAL

Another defining moment in his career. In the 1969 European Cup semi-final against Manchester United at San Siro, Milan's star playmaker Gianni Rivera was injured early on. Fogli came off the bench to replace him and produced a colossal performance, **nullifying the threat of Denis Law** and driving Milan to a 2-0 victory. Milan went on to win the European Cup and the Intercontinental Cup that year.

4 · TACTICAL DNA (80-PHILOSOPHY FRAMEWORK) — INFERENTIAL ONLY

> ⚠ **Tier 3 blocked — the percentages below are inferential analyst estimates only.** They are NOT derived from a scored Tier 3 event log, NOT video-validated, and NOT FGA output. **Do not present these numbers as measured performance.**

CHART 1 · PHILOSOPHY FIT — BAR

Inferential qualitative estimates. Not Tier 3 validated.

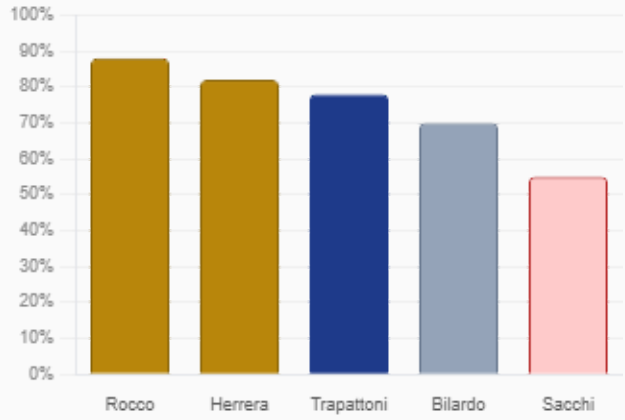


CHART 2 · PHILOSOPHY FIT — RADAR

Same inferential estimates across the five philosophies.

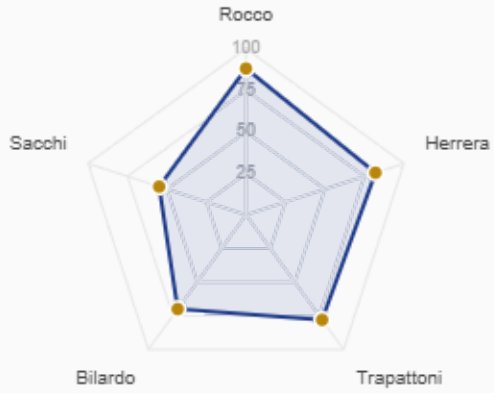


CHART 3 · PHILOSOPHY FIT — VALUES

Bar-length = inferential band. Percentage is the analyst estimate for this file only.

Rocco Fortress (#14)	**88%**	Direct System
Herrera Catenaccio (#13)	**82%**	Era Match
Trapattoni Dominance (#18)	**78%**	Inferred
Bilardo Planner (#45)	**70%**	Inferred
Sacchi Synchrony (#17)	**55%**	Low

PRIMARY — ROCCO FORTRESS (#14) · 88% INFERENTIAL

The strongest direct system link. Fogli played under Nereo Rocco at AC Milan during the 1968-69 season, winning the European Cup and Intercontinental Cup. Rocco's pragmatic, defensively solid, and tactically flexible approach required midfielders who could combine technical quality with tactical discipline. Fogli was the perfect fit: a *regista* capable of both creating and destroying.

SECONDARY — HERRERA CATENACCIO (#13) · 82% INFERENTIAL

The era and rival link. Fogli's Bologna faced Helenio Herrera's Inter in the famous 1964 Scudetto playoff. While Fogli was not a pure *catenaccio* player, the tactical context of 1960s Italian football — the emphasis on defensive solidity, tactical fouling, and individual duels — shaped his game. He was a product of that era's tactical evolution.

TERTIARY — TRAPATTONI DOMINANCE (#18) · 78% INFERENTIAL

The lineage link. Fogli was a pioneer of the technical, ball-playing *mediano* in Italy. Trapattoni, who later perfected the role at Juventus and Inter, inherited and refined that template. Fogli was the prototype; Trapattoni was the culmination.

5 · TACTICAL DNA PAIRING (PLAYER ARCHETYPE) — SAME-POSITION ONLY

> ⚠ **Same-position archetypes only (central midfielder / deep-lying playmaker).** The percentages below are inferential analyst estimates, not Tier 3 scores. Wingers, forwards, and defenders are excluded.

CHART 4 · PLAYER PAIRING — BAR

Inferential similarity scores. Not Tier 3 validated.

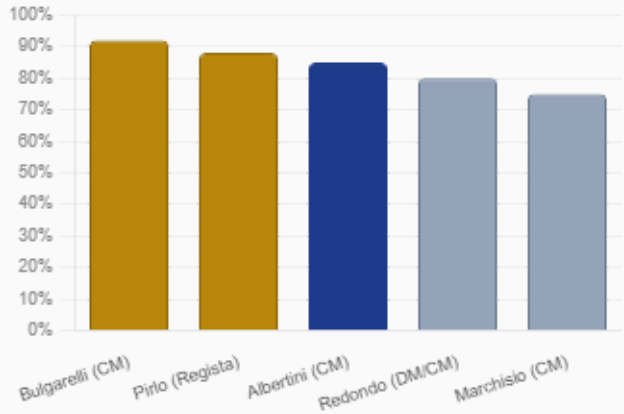


CHART 5 · PLAYER PAIRING — RADAR

Same inferential scores across the five same-position archetypes.

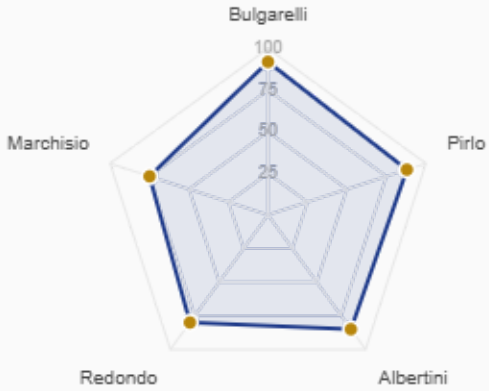


CHART 6 · PLAYER PAIRING — VALUES (SAME-POSITION ONLY)

Bar-length = inferential band. Percentage is the analyst estimate for this file only.

Giacomo Bulgarelli (ITA)	CM	**92%**	Same position
Andrea Pirlo (ITA)	Regista	**88%**	Same position
Demetrio Albertini (ITA)	CM	**85%**	Same position
Fernando Redondo (ARG)	DM/CM	**80%**	Same position
Claudio Marchisio (ITA)	CM	**75%**	Same position

PRIMARY — GIACOMO BULGARELLI (ITALY, CENTRAL MIDFIELDER) · 92% INFERENTIAL

The closest stylistic and career-context match. Bulgarelli was Fogli's teammate at Bologna and his successor as the club's midfield metronome. Both were **technically gifted, tactically intelligent central midfielders** who dictated the tempo of the game. They played together in the 1964 Scudetto-winning side, and their partnership was central to Bologna's success.

SECONDARY — ANDREA PIRLO (ITALY, DEEP-LYING PLAYMAKER) · 88% INFERENTIAL

The modern archetype of the Italian *regista*. Pirlo inherited the lineage that Fogli helped create: the technical, deep-lying midfielder who controls the game with passing and positioning rather than physicality. Same position, same national tradition, similar physical profile.

TERTIARY — DEMETRIO ALBERTINI (ITALY, CENTRAL MIDFIELDER) · 85% INFERENTIAL

A direct descendant of the Fogli archetype. Albertini was the **metronome of Capello's great Milan sides** in the 1990s — a technically excellent passer who combined defensive awareness with creative distribution. Same position, same club, same national lineage.

REFERENCE — FERNANDO REDONDO (ARGENTINA, DEFENSIVE MIDFIELDER) · 80% INFERENTIAL

An elegant, left-footed midfielder who shared Fogli's ability to **dictate play from deep**. Redondo was more of a pure destroyer than Fogli, but the technical grace and tactical intelligence are a valid comparison.

REFERENCE — CLAUDIO MARCHISIO (ITALY, CENTRAL MIDFIELDER) · 75% INFERENTIAL

A modern Italian midfielder who combined **technical quality with tactical discipline**. Marchisio was more of a box-to-box player than Fogli, but the national tradition and stylistic ethos are consistent.

EXCLUDED (WRONG POSITION)

PLAYER	POSITION	REASON FOR EXCLUSION
Gianni Rivera	Attacking Midfielder	Playmaker, not a deep-lying or box-to-box midfielder.
Sandro Mazzola	Attacking Midfielder	Different role entirely.
Mario Corso	Winger	Different role.

6 · RISK VS. REWARD — HISTORICAL DIAGNOSTIC

STRENGTHS (DOCUMENTED)	LIMITATIONS & GAPS (DOCUMENTED)
• **Serie A champion 1963-64** with Bologna LEGA SERIE A • **European Cup and Intercontinental Cup** winner with Milan in 1969 UEFA • **Man of the Match** in the 1964 Scudetto playoff GUERIN SPORTIVO • **"Caposcuola"** of the Italian technical midfield revolution CALCIO ILLUSTRATO • **Technically pure** — "tecnica pura, ai limiti del lirismo" CALCIO ILLUSTRATO • **Tactical versatility** — played as a *regista*, a *mediano*, and a box-to-box midfielder GUERIN SPORTIVO	• **No Tier 3 event log** — every sub-metric is unscoreable • **Source is a retrospective magazine feature**, not contemporaneous match reporting • **Part of the 1966 World Cup disaster** against North Korea FIGC • **Slight physical frame** — 1.72 m and 69 kg GUERIN SPORTIVO • **No per-match data**, line-ups, or opposition detail to anchor match-level claims • No second scout; reliability untested

7 · VALIDATION STATUS & REQUIRED ACTIONS

REQUIREMENT	STATUS
Minimum 5 matches registered	❌ 0 — NO MATCH LOG EXISTS
Video completeness (of 12)	❌ 0/12 — NO FOOTAGE SUPPLIED
FGA_v3_Final activation	❌ BLOCKED
COACH metric	❌ NOT POSSIBLE — HISTORICAL SUBJECT
Second scout	❌ NOT ASSIGNED
Tier 1 statistical foundation	⚠ PARTIAL — HONOURS AND CAREER TOTALS ONLY
Biographical data	✅ COMPLETE — GUERIN SPORTIVO, CALCIO ILLUSTRATO, FIGC
Philosophy DNA fit	⚠ INFERENTIAL ONLY — PERCENTAGES ARE ESTIMATES
Player pairing	⚠ SAME-POSITION ONLY, INFERENTIAL — PERCENTAGES ARE ESTIMATES

DATA INTEGRITY FLAGS

#	FLAG	IMPACT	ACTION
1	Retrospective source	Guerin Sportivo feature is not contemporaneous match evidence	Source contemporaneous press for the 1960s era
2	No match line-ups or scorelines	No match-level anchor	Obtain printed XIs and match reports
3	Source is a magazine feature, not a match report	Narrative and quotations only	Treat as documentary reconstruction
4	No second scout	Reliability of any eventual score cannot be tested	Assign on first scoring pass

PUNCH LIST

#	ITEM	PRIORITY
1	Build a 5–10 match midfielder event log from available footage	HIGH
2	Score technical, passing, and positional metrics first: TEC, PVI, LGP, OTP, POS	HIGH
3	Add defensive and physical metrics: TAC, INT, COV, END	MEDIUM
4	Source contemporaneous match reports for the 1964 Scudetto playoff and the 1969 European Cup semi-final	MEDIUM
5	Assign second scout for blind cross-validation	MEDIUM

8 · HISTORICAL CONTEXT & LEGACY

Romano Fogli is the **archetypal Italian technical midfielder** of the 1960s: a player whose elegance, intelligence, and tactical versatility made him one of the most respected midfielders of his generation. Born in Santa Maria a Monte, he came through the Torino youth system before joining Bologna in 1958, where he became the heartbeat of the team that won the 1963-64 Serie A title.

His performance in the 1964 Scudetto playoff against Inter is part of Italian football folklore. Fogli scored the opening goal with a deflected free-kick and provided the assist for Nielsen's decisive second, earning Man of the Match honours. It was a performance that cemented his reputation as a big-game player.

He later moved to AC Milan, where he played a crucial role in their 1969 European Cup triumph. In the semi-final against Manchester United, he came off the bench to replace the injured Gianni Rivera and produced a colossal defensive midfield performance, nullifying Denis Law and driving Milan to victory. He also played in the Intercontinental Cup against Estudiantes.

The honest reading of this file is therefore twofold. **As archetype language**, Fogli is a high-confidence example of the Italian *regista*: technically pure, tactically intelligent, and capable of combining defensive discipline with creative distribution. **As FGA evidence**, the file is thin: a single retrospective magazine feature, no event log, no video, no line-ups, no second scout. The correct output is a **blocked FGA status** with a documented unblock path — not a fabricated number.

ESN Empire Scouting Network

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Report ref ESN-RFO-2026-001 (v1.0) · Method: Empire FGA Archive Protocol · 50/30/20 master weighting · Tier 3 midfielder block · 80-Philosophy Framework (v3.2 draft) · no video scoring performed · no composite computed

Evidence base: 280+ top-flight matches (Torino, Bologna, Milan, Catania) · 13 caps (Italy) · Serie A 1963-64 · European Cup 1968-69 · Intercontinental Cup 1969 · Primary-source *Guerin Sportivo* (2026-09) & *Calcio Illustrato* (1966) features · FIGC · no match log · no video log.

Status: DRAFT — HISTORICAL ARCHIVE. **Tier 3 0/12 · Tier 2 not computable · Tier 1 partial · FGA_v3_Final BLOCKED · Numeric rating NOT ASSIGNED.** No COACH metric. No second scout. Philosophy fit percentages and player pairing percentages are **inferential analyst estimates** — not Tier 3 output. Pairing restricted to **same-position players only** (central midfielder / deep-lying playmaker). This document is a historical reference file, not a scouting assessment.

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